This is excellent with croûtes (see p39). Top them with grated Gruyère or Cheddar and some freshly ground black pepper, then put them under the broiler until bubbling.

onion and garlic soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 40 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

1 tbsp olive oil
1 tbsp butter
1 Spanish onion, finely chopped
1 large shallot, very finely chopped
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
½ cup hot water
1 small head of garlic, broken up into individual cloves but left unpeeled
⅔ cup dry white wine
2½ cups hot vegetable stock or chicken stock
½ cup whole or skim milk
2 egg yolks
4 heaped tbsp heavy cream
1 heaped tsp Dijon mustard

1 Heat the oil and butter in a large sauté pan or other heavy-based pan over medium heat. Add the onion and shallot, season lightly with salt and ground black pepper, and cook for 3 minutes, stirring constantly. Lower the heat, add the hot water, and cook gently, stirring frequently, for 20 minutes or until the water has evaporated and the onion mixture is very soft.

2 Meanwhile, bring some lightly salted water to a boil in a small pan. Add the garlic and bring back to a boil, then lower the heat and simmer for 10–15 minutes or until very soft. Drain, then refresh under cold running water. Pour the wine, stock, and milk into the onion mixture and bring to a simmer over medium heat, stirring occasionally.

3 Working over a bowl, squeeze each garlic clove between your thumb and forefinger until the flesh pops out. Add the egg yolks, then mash the garlic, stirring to make a smooth mix. Gradually whisk in the cream. Pour in 3 tbsp of the simmering soup and whisk well. Season lightly with salt and freshly ground black pepper. Whisking vigorously, pour or spoon the garlic mixture into the soup, keeping the pan over low heat. Stir in the mustard, adjust the seasoning, and serve.